

OE3C Planning Meeting 5

Date: 15 Dec 2025

Location: Online

Time: 10:01 – 11:35 AM

Attendees: Lyllian Corbin, Alex Wilder, Reem Mahamoud, Rasa Khosrowshahli, Sarah Hein, Nicholas Benton, Matthew Summerville, Madelaine Legault, Cassia Hamilton, Wylan Clitheroe, Lauren Nesbitt, Harry Kumbhani, Miriam Richards, Kiyoko Gotanda

Chair: Alex Wilder

Minutes by: Lyllian Corbin

[Recap: OE3C LOC Standing meeting time Monday, December 15 | Meeting | Microsoft Teams](#)

Meeting started at 10:01 AM.

Call to Order and Approval of Minutes

- Alex moved to approve the 01 Dec 2025 meeting minutes
 - o No abstains, meeting minutes were approved

Land Acknowledgement

- Contact Alex about questions on an OE3C specific land acknowledgement to include on the OE3C website

Logo Discussion with Lauren

- Logo is finalised (Badger with Ontario trillium flower and windmill)
 - o Lauren will send the logo to Rasa to put on the website
 - o Alex wants to ask Alex Popescu to create a 3D printed version of the badger
 - Lauren suggested placing the badger on the registration table or using the badger for the awards ceremony
 - o Lauren uploaded the logo to the Files and Documents channel in Teams

Workshops and Outings Discussion with Nick and Madelaine

- Nick and Madelaine held a subcommittee meeting with Wylan
 - o Discussed results from their last poll to solidify ideas
 - Probable ideas that will be planned for OE3C:
 - A guided hike with a scavenger hunt
 - o Wylan needs confirmation if we want to host multiple hikes on the same day (or different days)
 - A tour of the Brock Wine Library
 - Photo competition
 - o Need to know if the banquet is happening for the conference so they can plan the workings/outings around that
- Discussion on the timing for workshops and outings
 - o Alex suggested contacting the Wine Library to discuss their availability/schedule
 - Alternative outing options should also be planned in case the weather is not suitable for hikes
 - Nick explained they thought of holding the hike(s) on the second or third day of the conference and have discussed backup options
 - Alex suggested that Wylan plan hikes within their capacity, but it might be good to hold hikes at different times of the day to showcase the diversity of the area
 - o Wylan agreed and is interested in doing this with different themes for each hike
- Madelaine discussed ideas for an Indigenous workshop
 - o Workshop with Cindy Biancanello from Hadiya'dagénhahs
 - Sarah suggested mentioning the workshop idea to Cindy
 - Alex suggested holding off for now so we can formally ask her with an official offer (a gift for partnering with the conference)
- Photo competition discussion
 - o We should also do the silent auction on submitted entries
 - Nick suggested having different categories for the auction and advertising sooner than later so people have a chance to brainstorm
 - Alex mentioned that we also need to think about what we will do with the money afterwards and that it would be good to have a mixed media contest
 - Madelaine asked where the materials would be stored
 - o Alex explained that we can hold things on the mezzanine of Pond (2nd floor) if we need the space

- Alex suggested that Nick and Madelaine contact Sarah for budget details regarding the workshops and outings

Keynote Update with Harry

- Uploaded form for ranking keynote speakers on Teams
 - o Harry will send out invites after receiving feedback through the form
 - Wants a diverse mix of speakers that study various taxa from different research fields
 - o Alex suggested holding a seminar series to prelude speakers for the conference, so people become familiar with the speakers
 - Harry agreed and suggested inviting the speakers to do a webinar if they are not able to come to the conference
 - Alex suggested waiting for further advice from Kiyoko on whether we should pursue this idea

Website Update with Rasa

- Rasa has worked through most of the feedback he received on the OE3C webpage
 - o He left questions on the feedback document and needs people to provide their names so he can follow up with everyone on his changes
 - o Needs all OE3C organising members' photos to put on the website
 - Alex mentioned that everyone should also update their roles on the Trello board
- Rasa had questions on which parts of the webpage should be navy blue
 - o Wylan suggested that the navy blue could be the background with red text on the accents, but the current version of the site works well
- The OE3C team suggested some revisions for the website:
 - o Matt – the spelling of his last name needs to be corrected
 - o Alex – the maps need to be updated to Brock's location and indigenous names for Carleton need to be taken off
 - Also suggested that we go through each draft of the website to give detailed feedback as Rasa works on things
 - o Reem – their name appears twice on the organising team tab
 - o Cassia – campus eats list needs to be updated
 - Alex – suggested we can reach out to Justin for help with updating the list
 - Matt – mentioned that the locations of buildings and Tim Hortons are based on Carleton, names need to be changed to Brock
 - o Wylan – their name needs to be added to the organising committee page

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- Sarah – their name also needs to be added to the organising committee page
- Harry – “planning your visit” page is focused on Ottawa and needs to be updated for Brock
- Rasa will hold a meeting with Matthew to proofread and revise the webpage

Budget update with Alex and Sarah

- Quick update from Alex: We received \$3000 from the FMS Dean's office and will be requesting \$3000 from the VPR Office
- Sarah explained that the expense approval form is now available under files and documents in Teams
 - All requests for expenses will be submitted using that form, which will include the purpose of the request and any details on time-sensitive expenses
 - Request form should be emailed to Sarah with Alex and Kiyoko cc'd on the email
- Sarah is also working on a timeline for when we should apply for scholarships

Registration discussion with Reem

- Reem talked to conference services about a registration website
 - Conference services offered two different websites, but one of them is still under construction
 - Current portal being used for registration is AudienceView
 - Information that needs to be included on the registration site:
 - Food restrictions
 - Accessibility concerns
- Registration for groups can be input manually by Reem
 - Miriam suggested letting people input their information themselves, so we don't have to track the information
 - We will be discussing and finalising registration costs
 - Current costs
 - Students = \$190
 - Post docs = \$225
 - Professors & faculty = \$250
 - Reem – do we want an early bird registration fee?
 - Kiyoko suggested building administrative fees into ticket costs and leaving out the early bird registration since that is not normally done for OE3C
 - Harry explained that for OE3C 2024, at Waterloo, undergrads from Waterloo registered for free

- Kiyoko explained we might not be able to afford that option (which will also likely lead to accumulating costs for catering and we risk people not showing up)
- Workshop registration
 - Reem explained that we can pull reports directly through the website to track registrants
 - Kiyoko suggested having a cap on the workshops
- We will provide comments on what to include/revised on the registration website

Rough schedule discussion

- Nick hasn't had time yet to think about the schedule while organising workshop ideas
 - Harry suggested that it would be good to know what workshops we want to do before building the schedule
- Poster session discussion
 - Harry – At Waterloo, posters were done before lunch and were set up outside of the area where talks occurred
 - Kiyoko remembered that the poster session was 1.5 hrs long, then a set of concurrent oral talks followed, then everyone went for lunch
 - Nick suggested it would be good to have people set up their posters early in the day so attendees can view the posters before the session
 - Alex – Do we want to hold the poster session(s) on Friday or Saturday?
 - Nick and Harry agreed on splitting the posters over the two days
 - We want posters on the 2nd and 3rd day of the conference
 - Kiyoko explained that Western had posters during lunch. Queens and Waterloo had posters over two days.
 - Alex – Lunch and learn? We can do the posters just before or just after lunch
 - Lyly suggested holding the posters just before lunch so people can continue their conversations after the poster session
 - Alex – Where do we want posters? Plaza or Goodman Atrium?
 - We are on board with using the Plaza corridors
 - We could spread presenters out over both floors
 - Goodman Atrium will be a back up option for posters
- Presentation session discussion
 - Alex – How do we want to split sections and topics?
 - Nick suggested that posters can be assigned to different floors

- Oral presentation speakers will be assigned to sections based on the theme
 - Lyly mentioned that if we hold the talks in Plaza there should be 8 rooms total, but some rooms are smaller than others
 - Kiyoko explained that the Thistle 250 rooms have room capacities of 60 people
 - Plaza rooms have a capacity of 20 to 45 people
 - Alex decided that we should book all of the rooms (Plaza and Thistle) so have know we have space to fit the talks
 - Nick suggested using lecture rooms from South Block
 - Kiyoko needs time to circle back to this because the system does not allow bookings in May yet
 - Cassia suggested Goodman rooms because those rooms were used for
 - Harry suggested that we should also consider how many talks we want per session

General discussion

- Conference services handling additional organisation tasks for an extra cost (~\$200 on top of the base \$500 fee for assisting with main logistics, such as registration)
 - We probably won't be using this option to save ourselves some money
- Parking passes
 - Lauren asked if we could get a discount for guests
 - Alex will ask parking services
- T-shirts
 - Lauren is talking to her dad about printing options

Meeting adjourned at 11:35 AM.

Appended meeting notes from OE3C meeting attendees:

Madelaine

Here are the notes from the outings/socials/workshops subcommittee:

- Poll results: most popular ideas are guided hikes, wine library tastings, photo contest, coding workshop, Indigenous-led workshops
 - Wylan would like to take on planning the guided hikes, to organize multiple around themes of conference, possibly some in early morning
 - Planning for photo contest underway, easiest to tackle now
 - Alex suggested we also do a silent art auction
 - Coding workshop will need Rasa's input
 - We will reach out to Cindy Biancanello for Indigenous-led workshops
- Are we going ahead with a banquet? Planning depends on banquet schedule